← Back **The Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence**
Graded Quiz • 30 min

Due Mar 23, 11:59 PM CET

Congratulations! You passed!

Grade received 93.33%

Latest Submission Grade 93.33%

To pass 80% or higher

Go to next item

1. The equation that is used to estimate the number of communicative civilisations in the galaxy is referred to as the:

1 / 1 point

- ○ The Sagan equation
- ○ The Pasteur Equation
- ◉ The Drake Equation
- ○ The Lowell equation

Correct
This is correct. It was named after the American planetary scientist, Frank Drake

2. The Drake equation contains which of the following terms?

1 / 1 point

- [x] The fraction of these planets where life develops

Correct
This is correct

- [x] The "lifetime" of communicating civilizations

Correct
This is correct

- [x] The fraction of stars with planets

Correct
This is correct

- [x] The number of Earth-like worlds per planetary system

Correct
This is correct

3. When the Drake equation was first proposed how many communicative civilizations were estimated?

1 / 1 point

- ○ About 1 million
- ○ About 50,000
- ◉ About 10,000
- ○ About 5

Correct
This is correct.

4. The hunt for alien intelligences is usually referred to as

1 / 1 point

- ◉ The Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence
- ○ The Hunt for Alien Civilisations (HAC)
- ○ The Search for Other Intelligences (SOTI)
- ○ The Search for Close Encounters of the Third Kind (SCETK)

Correct
This is correct

5. In a Nature paper of what year did Philip Morrison and Guiseppe Cocconi first propose the search for extraterrestrial intelligence?

1 / 1 point

- ○ 1963
- ◉ 1959
- ○ 1927
- ○ 1824

Correct
This is correct

6. Which region of the electromagnetic spectrum was favoured in early searches for extraterrestrial intelligence and continues to be used today.

1 / 1 point

- ○ Sound
- ○ Visible light
- ◉ Radio waves
- ○ Ultraviolet radiation

Correct
This is correct. The atmosphere is almost transparent to radio waves so they are one of the most promising ways to search for ET signals

7. The building of which radio telescope in the 1950s was one of the major encouragements to the idea of SETI?

1 / 1 point

- ○ The Tatel Telescope in West Virginia
- ◉ The Lovell telescope in Manchester, UK
- ○ The Parkes Telescope, Australia
- ○ Arecibo Dish Observatory

Correct
This is correct

8. The first serious search for ET signals was initiated in 1960. What was its name?

1 / 1 point

- ○ Project Obama
- ◉ Project Ozma
- ○ Project Ozzie
- ○ Project Onslo

Correct
This is correct. It was initiated by Frank Drake using the 84ft Tatel Telescope in West Virginia

9. Project Phoenix was an attempt to search for ET signals in 1995. How many stars did it search?

1 / 1 point

- ◉ About 800
- ○ About 1300
- ○ About 50
- ○ About 250

Correct
This is correct

10. The Serendip project was an example of what?

1 / 1 point

- ◉ A project that piggybacked on existing radio telsecopes to find ET signals
- ○ A project that used satellite dishes on people's houses, all linked over the internet to search for ET signals
- ○ A project that linked up multiple radio telescopes to search for ET signals to improve accuracy
- ○ A project that used new telescopes to upgrade the search for ET signals

Correct
This is correct. It used the Arecibo dish observatory to survey stars

11. The 'WOW' signal in 1977, detected at the Big Ear radio telescope of The Ohio State University is thought to have been what:

1 / 1 point

- ○ A signal from a satellite
- ◉ There is no conclusive indication of what it was
- ○ An alien signal
- ○ An aircraft signal

Correct
This is correct. However, there is no compelling evidence that it was extraterrestrial (intelligent) in origin

12. The Pioneer 10 and 11 plaques placed on these two spacecraft contained which of the following information?

0 / 1 point

- [ ] A picture of a collection of animals
- [ ] A picture showing the location of the Earth
- [x] A picture of a man and a woman

Correct
This is correct

- [ ] A picture of DNA
- [ ] A picture of the Earth

You didn't select all the correct answers

13. Which scientist said this about the records sent into space on the Voyager spacecraft: 'The launching of this 'bottle' into the cosmic 'ocean' says something very hopeful about life on this planet.'

1 / 1 point

- ◉ Carl Sagan
- ○ Giordano Bruno
- ○ Charles Darwin
- ○ Frank Drake

Correct
This is correct

14. Which of the following was included in the Arecibo Message, broadcast to the globular star cluster M13 in 1974?

1 / 1 point

- [x] Image of Arecibo telescope

Correct
This is correct

- [x] Population of Earth

Correct
This is correct

- [x] Double helix structure of DNA

Correct
This is correct

- [ ] A picture of a horse
- [x] Atomic numbers of H, C, N, O, P

Correct
This is correct

15. Despite many searches, at the time of writing there is still no evidence for extraterrestrial intelligence despite the possibly high number of habitable planets in the galaxy. What is this paradox called?

1 / 1 point

- ○ The Darwinian Paradox
- ◉ The Fermi Paradox
- ○ The ET paradox
- ○ The Alien Paradox

Correct
This is correct. It was named after physicist Enrico Fermi